India Employee Handbook 2026

HR Policies | Version 1.0 | Effective date: 1 January 2026

IMPORTANT: This is a fictional sample document created for HRMS demonstration/testing. It is not an official company policy or legal advice. Replace organization-specific details and have HR/legal teams review it before real-world use.

1. Welcome and purpose

This sample handbook introduces general workplace expectations and common HR processes for an India-based organization. It should be customized to the organization, employee category, location, and applicable law.

2. Employment and onboarding

- Employment terms are defined by the appointment letter and applicable policies.
- Employees should provide accurate onboarding, bank, tax, and emergency-contact information through approved channels.
- Company property and access credentials are issued according to role and must be returned or disabled when employment ends.

3. Working hours, attendance, and remote work

Team schedules, weekly offs, shift arrangements, attendance recording, and remote/hybrid eligibility are set by the applicable employment terms and local policy. Employees should record attendance accurately and inform their manager of delays or absence.

4. Leave and holidays

Leave categories, accrual, carry-forward, encashment, and holiday calendars are governed by the organization's current leave policy and applicable law. Submit requests through the HRMS and wait for approval where required.

5. Compensation and benefits

Salary components, payroll dates, deductions, statutory contributions, insurance, and reimbursements are explained in the appointment letter and current benefit documents. Employees should report payroll discrepancies to HR/payroll.

6. Conduct and equal opportunity

- Maintain professional and respectful conduct.
- Do not discriminate, harass, bully, retaliate, or falsify records.
- Protect confidential information and respect intellectual-property obligations.
- Disclose conflicts of interest and follow gifts, expenses, and anti-bribery rules.
- Use grievance and whistleblowing channels in good faith.

7. IT, privacy, and information security

Follow acceptable-use, password, MFA, data-classification, device, and incident-reporting requirements. Access personal or employee data only when authorized and necessary for work.

8. Performance, learning, and feedback

Goals, feedback, performance reviews, learning opportunities, and promotion decisions follow the organization's published process and role-specific expectations.

9. Separation and exit

Notice periods, final settlement, exit interviews, handover, and return of assets are governed by the employment agreement, policy, and applicable law. Coordinate with HR and the manager to complete the exit checklist.

10. Questions and policy precedence

Contact HR for the current official policy set. If this sample conflicts with a signed employment agreement, an approved company policy, or applicable law, the controlling document or law takes precedence.

11. Employee acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received access to the employee handbook and understand that I should consult HR for the official policies applicable to me.

Employee name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

12. Document control

Owner: Human Resources | Review cycle: Annual | Status: Sample / requires HR and legal review